SEASIDE GRILL

HOST / HOSTESS

Training Manual

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Table of Contents

Host Training 1

Host Job Description 2

Hospitality & Service Standards 3

General Job Guidelines And Responsibilities 4

Providing Exceptional Hospitality 6

Host Roles 8

First & Last Impressions 9

Greeting, Seating, and Serving the Guest 11

- Steps to Greeting the Guest 11
- Steps to Seating the Guest 13
- Rotating Guest Seating 15
- Handling Types of Guests 16

Menu Presentation 17

To-Go Service Procedures 18

Preventing Guest Complaints 20

- Handling Guest Complaints 21

Sidework Duties 22

End of Shift/Checkout Procedures 32

In Summary 33

Host Training

We welcome you to **Seaside Grill**. As a Host, you are responsible for creating a positive first impression and making every guest feel welcome, special and appreciated. You can accomplish this by meeting and exceeding your guest's expectations.

We take great pride in our quality food and friendly, responsive service. We will provide you with the training you need to be successful. Our high standards can only be maintained through great people like you who share our values and desire to do the very best job possible for our guests every day.

The guidelines listed on the following pages will help you in your effort to provide these qualities to our guests. Along with the hands-on training you will receive, this manual will provide answers to questions you may have regarding your tasks, responsibilities, and operating procedures for **Seaside Grill.** Once again, welcome to the **Seaside Grill** Team!

Below you will find the *Host* topics covered in this guide.

1. Host Job Description
2. Hospitality & Service Standards
3. Providing Exceptional Service
4. Host Roles
5. First & Last Impressions
6. Greeting, Seating, and Serving the Guest
7. Menu Presentation
8. Phone Procedures
9. Reservation Procedures
10. To-Go Service Procedures
11. Preventing Guest Complaints
12. Performing Sidework Duties
13. End of Shift/Check Out Procedures

Host Job Description

Job Summary

As a Host, you will greet guests as they enter the restaurant in a courteous, friendly and helpful manner. Take reservations or put guests on wait lists. Provide menus and shows guests to their seats. May take phone orders and assist with bussing and resetting tables. Bid Guests farewell, ensuring we exceeded their expectations.

Job Standards

- Follow all policies and procedures as outlines by the company.
- Maintain a positive attendance record by reporting to work for assigned shifts at the scheduled time.
- Follow all sanitation and safety standards set forth by the company.
- Meet all uniform, appearance, and grooming standards as specified by the company.
- Maintain guest service philosophy by following guest service standards.
- Know menu items offered at the restaurant and be able to explain specials to guests.
- Maintain a waitlist when immediate seating is limited and seat guests within 3 minutes of the quoted wait time.
- Accommodate special seating requests for guests whenever possible.
- Communicate reservations for large parties to management and kitchen staff to ensure readiness.
- Conduct a first greet with guests within 30 seconds of guests arriving to the restaurant.
- Understand table numbering procedures and rotate tables properly through server sections.
- Upon seating, provide guests menus and inform them of their server names.
- Bid guests farewell upon departing, ensuring their satisfaction and inviting them to return.
- Perform assigned sidework duties satisfactorily.
- Follow all end-of-shift checkout procedures as outlined by the company.
- Maintain a good team environment by assisting other team members with their station duties and sidework when there is a need and/or when available.

Hospitality & Service Standards

The Host Team's goal is to make guests feel instantly welcome and acknowledged when they walk through our doors. To ensure our guests have a memorable visit, we must deliver exceptional service and memorable hospitality.

Hospitality (Emotional Aspect of Guest Experience)	Service (Technical Aspect of Guest Experience)
It's how you make guests feel	**It's what you do for the guest**

You are the first person a guest sees; so, greet them with a genuine, welcoming smile, eye contact and positive confident body language. The guest's first impression of our Restaurant is you. All incoming guests must receive a friendly, sincere greeting.

As the Host/Hostess, you are also the last person the guest will come in contact with. When the guest leaves, the door should be opened, the guest thanked, and invited to return. Provide the guest with a positive last impression of **Seaside Grill**.

Our Hosts are successful because of TEAMWORK. In order for a team to function effectively, it must be guided by certain basic principles. You are expected to adhere to the information, instructions, and philosophies in this manual.

Remember, you set the tone for the ultimate guest experience. The smiles you put on people's faces through your dealings with them -- whether answering the phone, greeting, saying goodbye, or answering questions -- can "MAKE A DIFFERENCE."

General Job Guidelines And Responsibilities

- Welcoming incoming guests in a friendly manner is your top priority. Whenever possible, open the front door for guests as they enter and leave.
- When speaking with a guest, always look the guest directly in the eyes, and stand erect. Never lean on the host stand or table.
- There should always be someone at the front door. If you must leave for a minute, have someone cover for you.
- Always address the guests in front of you first. If you are completing a seating "transaction," or answering the phone, let the guests know you will be right with them.
- Your appearance and attitude are critically important. Guests watch the operation you perform, so do not look disorganized or angry. If you are having a problem, ask the Manager to help you.
- Know the daily floor plans, sections and the servers working these sections. This will be important to know so you can inform servers when their section has been seated.
- When talking on the phone, always smile, it will make you feel good, and the caller can hear the smile in your voice!
- Keep Host stand and menus clean, sanitized and organized.
- No employees are to receive phone calls. If caller says it is an emergency, find a Manager.
- When you looking for people, do not carry your description or wait list. Read the description, then go find the guest. Sometimes, the guests enroute will stop you and ask you where they are on the list.
- If you are going over your estimated times, immediately inform the Managers so that the wait staff can be alerted.
- Never handle a glass by the rim with your hand over the drinking surface.
- Never handle silverware with your hand over the eating surface.
- When handling plates or food, never let your hand touch the eating surface or the food.
- Know your schedule.
- Know what time to be here for each shift.
- Know what the daily specials are and what they cost.
- Know the history of the restaurant.

- Know the managers.
- Avoid any long conversations at any particular table. This will only keep you away from the front door.
- Clear your mind of everything except work when you walk in the door. Guests can tell when their host is not totally mentally present with them, and it has a negative impact on the guests' experience.
- If you get behind, ask for assistance. You'll never get in trouble for asking.
- Keep yourself geared up so that you are ready for any rush. We get most of our complaints during the Restaurant's slow period.
- If you learn an order is delayed in the kitchen, inform the manager. The manager will go to the table and explain the situation as well. Get your stories straight. Never hide from guests.
- Learn to use your time wisely. Consolidate your trips. Scan the dining room for open tables as you are seating guests. This is the secret to running volume and making more money.
- If an entire section clears at one time, pace seating so the server can provide excellent service or ask for help. Think ahead.
- You won't believe how patient people will be if they just see you. Don't hide from your guests. Never spend more than two minutes away from your station.
- Anytime you serve on a guest, put yourself in their place and ask yourself if you would be happy with the job you did at that table.
- If one person asks for something at a table, make sure you ask everyone at the table if they too would like that item. Inform their server immediately.
- NEVER SIT DOWN WITH A GUEST or friend while on duty, even if they ask you to.
- If you must use the restroom during the shift, ask someone if they will please watch your station while you are gone, and inform a manager so that they are not looking for you.
- Unauthorized persons are not allowed in the kitchen. If one appears, politely but firmly escort them out and get the manager, or whomever it was they wanted to speak to.
- No server is to change his or her station or pick up extra tables without the consent of the manager on duty.
- Never walk away from a table without acknowledging its requests.

Providing Exceptional Hospitality

The level of service provided at a restaurant is what separates the good from the bad, to the ***Exceptional***! We want all our team members to make each guest's experience memorable. The following are ways to provide exceptional service as a Host.

When acknowledging and greeting the guest…

You only have one chance to make a first impression.

- Be polite and give a genuine greeting.
- Make each guest feel like you care about him or her. Never use greetings like "How many in your party?" Ask that after you've made them feel welcome and appreciated.
- If it is a repeat guest, use his or her name, and ask if he or she would like the same table as before. Show the guest that you remember and appreciate his or her return.

When showing a guest to a table…

- Set tables for larger parties, bring out highchair or booster seats for children and ensure the table is completely ready before you seat the guests.
- Pace yourself with the guests' gait. Allow the guest time to walk to the table and read special boards. Do not rush the guest.
- Look for service opportunities. For example, notice if the guest has stopped looking at the menu and the server is not around. Ask if they have any menu questions and let them know their server will be right with them.

..When using the waitlist…

- Take names following our waitlist standard and call people in the order they arrive.
- If someone does not respond after calling them the second time, call for the next party on the list.
- Give waiting guests accurate wait times within 5-10 minutes of your estimate.
- Be considerate to the guest by letting him or her know if the time needs to be extended for some reason and offer a beverage.
- When there is a wait, "sell" the wait rather than "challenge" a guest.

Sell the Wait…	***Translation…***
"Welcome! May I have the number of guests in your party?" (guest response) *"There is a 10-15 minute wait. Would you like me to add you to the waitlist?"* (guest response) *"Wonderful. May I have a name for the party?"* (guest response) *"Thank you so much Mr./Mrs. _____. If you would like, you are more than welcome to enjoy a drink at the bar. I'll come get you as soon as your table is ready."*	*"I know waiting isn't fun, but I'll do everything I can to make that wait as short and enjoyable as possible. I am happy you are here!"*
Avoid…	***Translation…***
"Four for dinner? There is a 15-minute wait!"	*"Your move – are you sure you want to wait? Your call, because we're too busy!"* You are treating them as and inconvenience and less than accommodating.

Make sure to follow up and…

- Be available for any questions by the guest.
- Offer to take empty dishes and glasses away from the table.
- Don't wait for the guest to say there is a problem with the order. Look for possible signs of dissatisfaction and inquire about the meal and experience.

Host Roles

As the host, your responsibilities are divided into three roles: Greeter, Seater, and Seating Coordinator.

- **Greeter** - Responsible for welcoming guests, learning about their needs. Provide a fond farewell to departing guests, affirming an excellent experience.
- **Seater** - Escort parties to their tables and assures their comfort. Monitor the dining room for open tables, resetting status. and prepare tables for arriving parties.
- **Seating Coordinator** - Maintain the speed, flow, and efficiency of seating the guests to minimize the time between when a guest leaves the table and when a new guest is seated at the table while properly pacing the restaurant. Maintain the floorplan, communicate to guests when their table is ready, and introduces them their server. Maintain the waitlist, communicate closely with servers, and frequently is the person responsible for answering the phone.

First & Last Impressions

First Impressions

"First impressions are lasting impressions."

We have all heard this saying before and it's true! Research shows that when we meet someone new, the other person forms a first impression of us in just 5-7 seconds. The information collected those first few precious seconds of a conversation - from your facial expressions to way you dress, the tone of your voice, eye contact, and body language - have a profound effect on how other people will initially perceive you.

You are the first face a guest sees when they walk in & the first voice they hear over the phone. You are the "First Impression" of our restaurant. You have a significant amount of influence on how guests enjoy their dining experience and if they decide to return. Never underestimate the importance of your position and the power of the first impression.

Last Impressions

Last impressions are just as important and critical as first impressions. How guests feel leaving **Seaside Grill** affects how they will view their entire dining experience. We want guests to leave feeling just as welcomed and appreciated as they did when they first walked through our front door.

Guests remember the beginning and end of their experience more vividly than everything that happens in the middle. Research call this the primacy effect and the recency effect. That means you have a huge impact in how guests feel about our restaurant. The way we treat guests at the front impacts if guests will return and bring their friends or family. Make sure guests feel just as special and appreciated when they leave as when they were greeted. How guests feel leaving our restaurant can impact how they view their entire experience!

"How guests feel leaving our restaurant affects how they will view their entire dining experience."

The Importance of Body Language

Communication occurs through both verbal and nonverbal means. Let's take a minute to focus on nonverbal behaviors such as appearance, body language, vocal tone, etc. Guests are constantly interpreting our nonverbal cues. What happens when we audibly say, "Hi. Welcome to Seaside Grill" to guests with a fake smile and our eyes focused on something besides them? Guests will interpret our greeting as insincere and may even think we are distracted because our body language was not in alignment with our verbal message.

If our nonverbal clues do not align with our verbal message, guests are more likely to believe the nonverbal clues. Here are a few pointers to make sure your body language leaves guests with a positive impression of you and our restaurant.

Do's	***Don'ts***
Smile & make eye contact ***Stand straight*** ***Face guests (feet pointed towards guest when speaking)*** ***Stand shoulder-to-shoulder with coworkers (backs always faced away from guests)*** ***Let guests have the right of way*** ***<u>10/4 Rule:</u>*** ➲ ***Acknowledge guests within 10 ft by smiling and making eye contact*** ➲ ***Verbally acknowledge guests within 4 ft***	***NEVER put your back to the entry*** ***Slouch*** ***Lean on the desk or wall*** ***Cross your arms*** ***Frown or look impatient*** ***Cross your feet*** ***Huddle with coworkers (aka, not paying attention to guest)***

Greeting, Seating, and Serving the Guest

The first impression you set with the guest lasts through the entire dining experience, so make sure you make a good one. It is important that your greeting is genuine and welcoming.

Steps to Greeting the Guest

Welcome Guests to the Restaurant

- Smile, make eye contact, and say, "Hello! Welcome to **Seaside Grill**. Have you ever been here before?" If not, express our appreciation for choosing our restaurant.
- Make a personal recommendation (popular menu item, dessert, etc.).

When Selecting a Table

- Determine guests' needs quickly.
- Ask the guest's preference with regard to table location when the dining room is not too crowded. *"Do you have a preference for sitting on the patio or in the dining room?"*
- Always know where the next three parties will be seated.
- Confirm the number of guests in each group and seat the group at a suitable table.
- Never say "Just one" to the single dining guest.
- Always seat in rotation whenever possible.
- Never seat a guest unless the table is ready to go.
- Seat guests with limited mobility where they will be most comfortable, or close to the door.
- Inform the manager whenever a server is "double or triple sat" so the manager may be available to assist the server as needed.
- Never tell a guest a section is closed. If he or she requests a table in a closed station, seat the guest immediately and ask a server to pick it up.

When Using a Waitlist

- Inform the guest that there is a short wait and reassure the guest that he or she will be seated as quickly as possible.
- Ask and record all the necessary information on the waitlist: Name, number of guests, arrival time, any seating preferences, and the quoted wait time.
- Quote an accurate time. A general formula to calculate the wait: multiply the number of names on the wait list by 2 minutes and add 5-10 minutes cushion to determine the wait time range. For example, if you have 5 parties X 2 = 10 + 5-10 minutes cushion, the wait time is 15-20 minutes.
- Always quote a range of time (for example, 10–15 minutes or 5–10 minutes).
- Indicate a place to sit or stand to wait that is out of the way of traffic or to take a walk on the boardwalk and come back at least 5 minutes before stated wait time.
- Thank the guest and let the guest know that we'll call him or her as soon as the table is ready.

When Calling Names from a Waitlist

- Approach the guest personally, whenever possible, to let him or her know the table is available.
  - When you call the party, update the Wait List
  - Draw the outline of a circle to the left of the guest's name.
  - When you seat the party, fill in the circle completely.
  - If a guest does not arrive promptly when his or her name is called:
    - Proceed to the next party on the list.
    - After a few minutes, call the guest a second time. Place a diagonal line in the circle next to the name.
    - If called a third time, place another diagonal line inside the circle to form an X.
  - Do not call the guest again after the third attempt. If a guest arrives after his or her name was called three times, give the guest the next available table, whenever possible.
- Record the actual seat time every 5th line. Track pace of wait – high or low – to ensure you are calculating wait times accurately.
- If a guest's wait time is running longer than the quoted wait time, contact the guest and keep them informed of the situation. This enables you to build trust with each guest.

HOSPITALITY TIPS

Walking guests to their table provides an awesome opportunity to connect. Here are a few ideas to get the conversation rolling:

- **If it is their anniversary, ask how many years they are celebrating. Let them know that you would be happy to take a picture of them on their way out. You can offer that with birthdays, too.**
- **When you seat guests, thank them for coming in and let them know who their server is.**
- **Offer to take pictures of guests leaving. A picture is worth a thousand words. Whenever they look at it, they will think of our restaurant (so make sure there is a good background). Guests absolutely love it.**

Steps to Seating the Guest

When Seating Guests

- Greet guests with a smile, make eye contact, use their name when possible. When you are ready to seat the party, use their name. For example, "*Mr. Anderson, you table is ready. If you would like to follow me, I'd love to show you the way."* Or a simple, *"Mr. Anderson, I'd love to show you to your table."*
- Walk at the guests' pace. Indicate caution when approaching ramps or steps.
- Pull out chairs when appropriate.
- Stand out of the guests' way. Wait for guests to sit before continuing.
- If a party does not want to sit where you are taking them, take them directly to the table they want to sit at.
- Provide a highchair, infant carrier sling or booster seat for children.
- Place an opened menu before each guest from the left side, ladies first.
- Especially if it is the guests' first visit, point out popular menu choices, specials, or make recommendations.

When Performing a Parting Phrase

- Wish the guests an enjoyable meal and ensure them that their Server will be right over. For example, "Mary will be right with you. Enjoy!"

When Returning to the Front Desk

- Let the Server know they have been seated and communicate any special occasions or needs the guests may have communicated to you during seating.
- Circulate the dining room to note available open tables and tables that are ready to "turn" on your way back to the host stand.
- Collect menus and return them to the host stand.

When Giving a Fond Farewell

- Greet all guests upon departure, whenever possible, with a smile and eye contact.
- Inquire about their experience to ensure complete satisfaction.
- If guest express any dissatisfaction whatsoever, ask them to stay to speak with a manager. Get the Manager immediately.
- Thank guests for visiting us and invite them to return soon.

Never say "Have a great night." Everyone says that. It's not special.

Instead, try saying:

"Thank you so much for being our guest."

"How was your dinner this evening? We look forward to seeing you again."

If it was a birthday or anniversary celebration, "Thank you so much for celebrating with you!"

"Thank you so much for dining with us. Have a wonderful rest of your evening."

"Thank you. Goodnight." (This is great when guests leave quickly. It is short and to the point. Adjust "goodnight" if it's an earlier in the day.)

Rotating Guest Seating

At the beginning of each shift, you will receive a floor plan with designated stations assigned to the servers. To ensure we provide the best service possible, it is essential to rotate seating from one station to the next whenever possible: i.e., station one, then two, three, etc. The Host's responsibility is to make sure that as guests leave a table, once it is cleaned and reset, new guests are rotated to that table, thereby ensuring that each server has proper guest rotation and receives the same number of tables as all other servers.

Avoid double seating a station unless the guest requests a particular table. Once you leave the Host stand to seat a party, be certain to post the time seated on that table on your floor plan. As business slows down, stations may close, and the floor plan will change. A Manager -- and Manager only -- can close stations and change the floor plan.

- Know the daily floor plans, sections and the servers working these sections. This will be important to know so you can inform servers when their section has been seated.
- Give each server the same number of parties.
- Distribute large parties evenly as much as possible, to ensure the best service.
- Watch for "waves". Avoid seating several tables at once. Stagger slightly to ensure proper service flow and prevent overloading the kitchen. Staggering seating allows the kitchen to execute the orders that are placed in a timely manner which in turn allows the service sequence to flow for the Guest.
- Know the tables that are best suited for large parties, so planning is the standard. Seat tables that would typically be pushed together for large groups at the same time, so they turn together.
- Parties of 4 or less can be seated at large tables, when on a wait, if it is convenient and comfortable for them.
- When a party requires an extra chair, infant carrier sling, highchair or booster chair, have it at the table before seating them.
- Honor the request of guest(s) over equal number of tables per server.
- Tables are bussed immediately after the party leaves and the table is to be seated within 45 seconds of bussing.

Handling Types of Guests

Because your position at the door is semi-stationary, guests will look to you to solve problems: i.e., lost items, questions about the wait, their seating arrangements, etc. No matter how busy you are, each guest must be treated with sensitive concern for their problems or interests.

Tact and diplomacy under pressure is a skill essential to your success at **Seaside Grill**. Your ability to smile and remain calm in the face of adversity will eliminate the stress encountered in your job. Often, the only solution to a problem will be to get a Manager. Do not hesitate to do this; however, most problems can be solved just by providing a listening ear. Different types of guests require different approaches to service. Here are some examples:

Type of guest	What to do….
The troublemaker	Be courteous, but do not be drawn into arguments. Do not participate in criticisms of the management or make statements that may be construed as complaints about the restaurant. Warn other team members serving the troublemaker type to avoid antagonizing him or her.
The late guest	Make the guest feel welcome. If the food selection is limited, explain that it is near closing time. Provide good service without making the guest feel hurried.
The hurried guest	Tell the guest in advance approximately how long the service will take. Give the best service possible under the circumstances.
The over-familiar guest	Be courteous but dignified with the guest. Avoid long conversations.
The grouchy guest	Meet the guest cheerfully and see that the server treats him or her pleasantly. Do not argue with the guest. Listen to any complaints courteously, but do not encourage conversation. Do not be distressed by unreasonable complaints.
The angry guest	Listen to the guest, express regret at the occurrence that prompted the complaint, thank the guest for calling the matter to your attention, and try to rectify the error.

Menu Presentation

Menu Presentation refers to the tableside presentation of the menu to the guests. This is also the best time for making recommendations. A complete knowledge of the menu is necessary for this presentation process to be successful.

During your training, you will be exposed to the menu and its ingredients. It is imperative you know the menu items and the accompaniments that go with them. This will enable you to assist any guest with questions in person, or on the phone.

Menu and Drink Prices

The prices will be listed in the Host Information Book. These prices may change, therefore, check with your management team to stay informed.

Specialties

Seaside Grill specializes in great burgers and tacos.

Specials & Features Of The Day

- The day's Specials will be discussed weekly.
- These specials may include **Taco Tuesday, Wing Wednesday, Etc.**
- You will present the "specials" verbally. This enables you to describe them thoroughly and answer any questions the guest may have.
- When presenting the specials, you should start with drink specials, then appetizers, and entrees. In describing the specials, you must use adjectives, which will entice the guests.

To-Go Service Procedures

Carry out food is common and a decent percentage of our sales. To-go orders are taken either by phone or by walk-in. When a guest picks up an order and takes it home to enjoy it, nothing can create a negative impression faster than an inaccurate order.

When Giving a Warm Welcome

- For walk-ins, immediately acknowledge the guests with a smile and eye contact upon arriving at the host stand.
- Say, “Hi! Welcome to Seaside Grill.”
- For phone orders, answer the phone within three rings.
- Always use a proper phone greeting.
- Always enter the order on the POS as you are taking it.
- Ask the guest if he or she may be placed on hold.
- No guest should be placed on hold for more than 30 seconds.
- Smile when you talk.

When Taking the Order

- Ask for the guest’s name and enter it immediately into POS.
- If it is a phone order, ask for the guest’s phone number and name.
- Ask if the guest would like plastic ware and/or condiments with the order.
- Ask the right questions about menu options, for example if a sandwich comes with a choice of side, or a salad is served with the choice of dressing, gather all information to ensure the item is served correctly.
- Suggest accompaniments such as side salads, appetizers, or beverages, like iced tea and sodas.
- Repeat the order back to ensure accuracy.
- Estimate the preparation time and inform the guest when the order will be ready. Quote a range of time in five-minute increments, such as 10–15 minutes.
- Be friendly and courteous throughout the conversation.
- Thank the guest for calling.

When Packing Up the Order

- Inspect each item to ensure that it matches what the guest ordered, and that the presentation is to our standard.
- Place all items neatly and carefully in the to-go bag, keeping hot and cold food separate.
- Place the appropriate number of condiments, plastic ware, and napkins in the bag.
- Prepare all beverages last so that they are fresh and delicious when the guest arrives.

When Presenting the Order

- Greet the arriving guest with a warm welcome!
- Be sure the order is ready at or before the quoted time.
- Open each bag and verbalize what the contents are.
- Ask if there is anything else the guest needs such as plastic ware or extra condiments.
- Retrieve any items requested.
- Process payment promptly.

When Giving a Fond Farewell

- Say goodbye to all guests upon departure, whenever possible with a smile and make eye contact.
- Thank guests for visiting and invite guests to return soon.

Preventing Guest Complaints

No restaurant is immune to guest complaints, but you can try to limit the severity or number of complaints by heading off an issue before it arises. To prevent complaints, you need to keep your eyes and ears open and be aware of the guests around you.

You can prevent complaints by always meeting the standards of service.

- **Serving quality products** – If you notice a product is not prepared to our level of standard, bring it to the attention of the cook or manager, and don't serve it!
- **Providing fast, accurate, friendly service** – Follow our guest service standards at all times.
- **Maintaining a clean restaurant** – Perform your sidework duties as assigned. If you notice an area that is not clean, take action immediately by cleaning it yourself, finding someone else that is available to clean it, or informing the manager.

You can also head off complaints by noticing signs of dissatisfaction:

- **Irritation when ordering or asking questions**
- **Disgusted, bored, or impatient facial expressions while waiting in line**
- **Half-eaten food left at the table (if more than usual)**
- **Gestures or comments among guests that express dissatisfaction**

When you notice any of these signs, ask the guest if there is something you can assist with, or if he or she is happy with the food and service. Determine what is wrong and remedy the situation as quickly as possible.

Talking with your guests informally during service can assist you with preventing problems before they happen. Perform check-backs at the table; ask your guests how they feel about the food quality and service. Guests who are comfortable talking with employees will be more willing to answer questions honestly, not pre-judge the restaurant, and be understanding when issues do arise.

Following these techniques, every day at the restaurant will limit guest complaints and provide a pleasing environment for our dining guests.

Handling Guest Complaints

It is important to deal with a guest's complaint quickly. If you do not attend to the guest immediately, he or she will leave feeling dissatisfied. An unhappy guest can damage a restaurant's reputation significantly. When handling a guest complaint, it is important that you follow the following steps:

Listen	Remain calm and listen to the nature of the complaint.
Acknowledge	Show sincere concern for the guest problem and find out all the details of the actual complaint.
Respond	Ask questions to make sure you understand the issue and tell the guest about the process that will be taken to resolve the complaint. Make sure that the guest agrees with this process.
Apologize	Apologize for any inconvenience.
Take action	Try to resolve the complaint by taking into account the guest's satisfaction and your own range of abilities (i.e., a replacement item, gift certificate, etc.)
Report	If you can't resolve the complaint, refer it on to your superiors.
Follow up	Complete all necessary reporting paperwork.

Here are some common guest complaints and our policies on what you should do to satisfy the guest. A guest complains of…

An incorrectly filled order:	Replace the order with the correct one immediately.
Food being spoiled or inedible:	If our quality is not up to standard, offer to replace the item and comp the ordered item. Call your manager and check the remaining food items on the line to ensure it doesn't happen again.
A dirty table or a messy restroom:	Apologize, thank the guest for pointing out the problem, and clean it immediately.
Extended wait time:	Apologize, thank the guest for his or her patience, and offer a free appetizer or drink.
A server spilling a drink or food item on a guest:	Apologize and offer to pay the cleaning bill for the clothing item.
Poor service or an impolite employee:	Promise to speak to the individual involved. Inform the manager about the problem or talk privately to the person about the complaint as soon as possible.

Sidework Duties

Duties performed by Hosts outside of greeting and seating guests are called sidework. These duties although may come second to seating the guest are just as important. They help to maintain the restaurant and make it a safe and pleasant place for guests to come and dine. Sidework is normally done at opening, during slow periods, and at the end of your shift. The following are typical sidework duties for the Host station.

Opening Duties

- Clean counter
- Wipe benches, highchairs, and booster seats
- Check printed menus with kitchen menu to discover omissions, inaccuracies, or corrections.
- Complete feature board
- Stock hostess stand:

  Waitlist
  Table station chart
  Menus to go
  Pens
  Paper to take to-go orders
  Rolled silverware
- Dust artifacts/blinds
- Ensure table arrangements are clean and orderly

During Shift

- Bus tables
- Wipe tabletops
- Wipe up crumbs
- Clean seats
- Sweep floor
- Wipe menus

Closing Duties

- Stock depleted items
- Organize host stand
- Wipe menus

End of Shift/Checkout Procedures

Checkout Procedures

Before beginning your checkout each shift, check the following:

- Make sure that all guests are seated.
- Be certain that all of your sidework and closing duties are completed.
- Have the manager or closing employee initial your host report indicating that you have successfully completed your sidework.
- Once your host report is initialed, hand in your report and slips to the manager to be verified.
- Have a manager do voids, over-rings, and promo tickets. An over-ring must be signed by a manager at the time it occurs and not at the end of the shift.
- Make sure that you have your full uniform on at all times while in the front of the house.

In Summary

Being a Host is fun, and it takes organization and awareness to be successful. Our goal is to help you become more organized during your shift so that you can become more competent and relaxed when the “big slam” does come.

In addition to demonstrating a friendly, enthusiastic demeanor, here are ways a Host can stay organized and ensure exceptional guest service is being provided:

Be Attentive

- If you notice guests are wanting to order, inform a server that the table is ready, direct another server, or take the order yourself. Do not let guests wait.
- Summon the server when the guest requests additional food or other service.
- Have tables cleared and reset promptly after the guests leave.

Be Prepared

- Come prepared. If you can, arrive at least 10 minutes before your shift is to begin. This will enable you to ensure you are in uniform and ready to go out on the floor.
- Make sure your waiting area is clean and organized.
- Make sure you have enough menus and that they are clean.

Stay Focused

- During your shift, try to put everything else aside that is on your mind or that you have been doing that day.
- You should always be keeping an eye on the walkway, watching for when new guests arrive.
- When guests enter, greet them appropriately. If you are busy with other guests, let the new guests know you will be right with them.

Multi-Tasking Tips

- When putting guests on the waitlist, show them the specials board and offer explanations of the specials.
- After seating guests, pre-buss or buss a table on the way back to the host station.
- Enlist your fellow team members for help.

If you assess the situation, thinking along the way how you can save yourself time and steps, you will be more organized and confident. **Most of all, you will have a lot more fun!**